

Incident Summary

1)Title Of the Incident

IPS:- Outbound Connection to Malicious Reputation IP (Ticket No:-CS-0206)

2)Incident Details

- **Receive Time:** - 2/23/25 8:29 AM
- **Source IP:** -
- **Destination IP:** -
- **Destination Port:-** 4500
- **Protocol:-** UDP
- **Threat Name:** - VPN Traffic
- **Action Taken:** - Allowed
- **Severity:** - NA
- **User:** - NA
- **Direction:** - Inbound

3)Description Of Incident

An IPS alert was generated for “**Outbound Connection to Malicious Reputation IP**” involving inbound VPN traffic. The connection attempt was observed on **UDP port 4500**, which is commonly used for **IPSec VPN (IKEv2/NAT Traversal)**.

- The **source IP (186.23.212.74)** was identified as external and flagged as having a malicious reputation.
- The **destination IP ()** belongs to the internal network and was the target of the inbound VPN traffic.
- Security devices logged the event, and the IPS allowed the traffic, categorizing it as **VPN Traffic**.

4)Investigation Summary

The alert “**Outbound Connection to Malicious Reputation IP**” was triggered when an external IP attempted to establish a VPN session with the internal VPN server.

- **Destination IP:** — (Server 2022, VPN, VM, High Priority, Team)
- **Source IP:**
 - Not part of the internal organization

- Reputation check: Reported **5,736 times from 814 distinct sources**, marked as **malicious**

Splunk Findings:

A total of **13 events** were logged across multiple sources:

- **Firewall:** 2 events (Allowed)
- **IPS:** 2 events (Allowed)
- **VPN Logs:** 9 events

VPN Authentication Activity:

- Multiple attempts with **MFA** and **password-based authentication** observed.
- Repeated **failed MFA authentications** flagged as *Suspicious*.
- Several events showed *pending OTP authentication* but did not complete.
- Password login attempts triggered prompts but no successful session establishment was recorded.

Key Observations:

- The malicious source IP attempted **multiple login methods** (MFA and password).
- All login attempts **failed**; no successful session was established.
- The traffic was **allowed by firewall and IPS**, but VPN logs correctly flagged repeated suspicious activity.
- This indicates a **possible brute-force or credential stuffing attempt** against the VPN gateway.

5)Action Taken

Source IP (186.23.212.74) was blocked at the firewall and IPS level to prevent further connection attempts.